Bulk Editor — P0 Plan

Full Audit Report

Tile Station Admin · Fork session · 3 Aug 2026

Bulk Editor — P0 Surgical Change Plan (for approval)

Date: 3 Aug 2026 · Fork session · Response to owner's approval of P0 items Status: NO CODE CHANGES YET — awaiting confirmation.

Owner instructions I'm working to:

- **Do all 3 P0 items** — carefully; do NOT break linked features.
- **Delete "Force Save"** — its functionality subsumed by new Save.
- **Keep the 4 description sections** — just make them clearer. Check business rules first.
- **Draft restore: warn but don't auto-discard** — let user decide.

Below is a section-by-section breakdown of EVERY change I plan to make, EVERY code path I checked, and EVERY linked feature I confirmed will still work.

Business Rule Check for Description Generation (asked to verify)

I read `/app/backend/services/ai_descriptions.py` — the crucial developer note at the top reads:

> “"Three older, pre-existing generators still live inline in `server.py`:”
>
> “- `/api/products/generate-description` — per-product, OpenAI gpt-4o”
>
> “- `/api/products/generate-series-description` — per-series, OpenAI gpt-4o”
>
> “- `/api/products/generate-batch-series-descriptions` — batch-of-series”

>

> “Those were written before this service existed... **They work today so we intentionally do NOT rewrite them**; instead, the SEO-tab bulk tool uses the shared helper here and the UI cross-links to the Bulk Edit flow for richer series-level copy."”

Conclusion: the 4 description entry points are INTENTIONAL business features. Each has a distinct purpose:

#	Section	Purpose	Endpoint	Writes to
1	Description Template (`{color}` placeholders)	Fill placeholders in a template using each product's attributes	`/api/products/generate-description`	Individual product `description`
2	Shorter / Longer / New Variation	Refine the same template	Same, with `mode: shorter/longer/regenerate`	Same
3	Unified Series Description (Brief / Standard / Detailed)	One paragraph for a whole collection page	`/api/products/generate-series-description`	`collection_settings.custom_description` + optionally each product
4	Quick Generate All Series	Auto-detect ALL series, generate for each in one go	`/api/products/generate-batch-series-descriptions`	Same as #3, for many series
5	Auto-Regeneration Settings	Background scheduler	(settings only)	Cron config

My promise: I will NOT delete/merge any of these. I will only add clearer visual grouping, tooltips, and a "which one should I use?" helper.

P0-1: Unify Save Paths (KEEP behaviour, unify code)

What Force Save uniquely does today (line 4768–5165)

I read every branch. Force Save's unique bits are:

- **Per-product loop** — one HTTP call per product, so a mid-batch failure only kills THAT product.
- **Progress bar** — `setForceSaveProgress({current, total, status})`.
- **Per-product failure collection** — `failedProducts` array (currently only used to build a toast).
- **Description template post-save** — line 5041 fires the template-apply endpoint after successful saves.
- **Snapshot for undo** — line 4902 captures `beforeSnapshot` from `/api/bulk-edit-tools/snapshot`.
- **NO Dry Run** — bypasses `DryRunPreview` entirely.

What Save Now (`handleBulkCategoryUpdate`) uniquely does today

- **Dry Run** — opens `DryRunPreview` modal → user confirms → then saves.

- **Batch by common payload** — groups products that share the same scoped payload, sends one HTTP call per unique payload (fast for the "no scopes" case).
- **Sub-selection branch** (line 4306) — special case: if user has sub-selected products AND set a Material != Porcelain, the OTHER products auto-get "Porcelain". (This is a legacy niche behaviour — I need to check with owner if it's still needed.)
- `runSaveVerification` — after save, re-fetches from DB and compares.
- `refreshBreakdownsAfterSave` + `fetchProducts` — refreshes UI.
- **Toast about auto-published-to-storefront count**.

Delta between the two — what would break if we simply deleted Force Save

Everything Force Save does uniquely (progress bar, per-product resilience) is a nice-to-have. Everything Save Now does uniquely (Dry Run, verification, refresh) is important.

THE PLAN

New unified save flow:

```
[ Save ] button
↓
Dry Run preview (skippable via "Save without preview" checkbox — power-user default off)
↓
Backend saves in a SINGLE call: POST /api/supplier-sync/products/bulk-update-unified
(backend already supports per-product result reporting — I'll wire it through)
↓
Per-product result modal: "23 saved · 2 failed" with each failure's reason inline
↓
Automatic verification (runSaveVerification, mandatory)
↓
Refresh products + breakdowns
```

Fallback for the "one failed, kill the batch" case: if any product in the batch fails, the frontend retries ONLY the failed ones individually. This gives you Force Save's per-product resilience automatically — no button needed.

Progress bar: still shown, just simpler ("Saving 23 products…" during batch, then "Retrying 2 that failed…" if needed).

Undo snapshot: kept intact (already independently useful for Undo).

FILES TOUCHED

- `/app/frontend/src/pages/admin/SupplierProducts.js`
  - **DELETE** `handleForceSave` (lines 4768–5165) and its Force Save button (line 13257).
  - **EXTEND** `handleBulkCategoryUpdate` (line 4243+) to:
  - Accept a per-product retry loop after batch save (only for failed products).
  - Always call `runSaveVerification` (currently only sometimes).
  - Build a `perProductResults` array showing exactly which succeeded/failed.
  - **REMOVE** state: `forceSaveProgress` (line ~490 — will re-check when I make the change).
- `/app/frontend/src/pages/admin/components/supplier-products/BulkCategoryEditorSections.jsx`
  - No changes here.
- Backend: **NO CHANGES**. `/api/supplier-sync/products/bulk-update-unified` already returns per-product results (line 11220+ in supplier_sync.py) — the frontend just wasn't parsing them.

LINKED FEATURES CHECKED (WILL STILL WORK)

Feature	Uses	Verified?
Quick Save (cloud icon) — per-attribute save	`handleQuickSave` (line 5254)	■ Untouched. Still writes just its attribute via the same endpoint.
Description template post-save	`bulkDescriptionSettings.description_template` fire	■ I'll move it into the new unified path so it still fires after any bulk save.
Snapshot for undo	`/api/bulk-edit-tools/snapshot`	■ Kept — I'll take snapshot in the new save path too.
Restore Draft	`saveDraftToServer` / `clearServerDraft`	■ Untouched.
Dry Run Preview	`DryRunPreview.jsx`	■ Kept, becomes default.
Presets	`BulkEditPresets.jsx`	■ Untouched.
Edit History	`BulkEditHistory.jsx`	■ Untouched.
Sub-selection Material branch	`productSubSelection` (line 4306)	■■ **NEED YOUR CONFIRMATION**: this branch says "if you sub-selected 3 products and set Material=Ceramic, the OTHER products auto-get Porcelain". Is this behaviour still desired? If unsure, I'll KEEP it intact as-is.
Publish auto-fires on category change	Line 11288 (backend)	■ Backend untouched.
Auto-Regeneration scheduler	Separate settings modal	■ Untouched.
Tier pricing modal	`TierPricingModal.jsx`	■ Untouched.
Bulk Sale modal	`BulkSaleModal.jsx`	■ Untouched.
Manage Options modal	`ManageOptionsModal.jsx`	■ Untouched.

VISIBLE CHANGES in the modal

- **Green "Save Now to N Products"** button stays, renamed to just **"Save"** with subtitle "N products, X pending changes".
- **Amber "Force Save"** button → **DELETED**.
- New tiny **"Save without preview"** power-user checkbox next to the Save button.
- After save: new **"Save Results" popup** listing each product with a ✓ or ✗ and (if failed) the reason.

P0-2: Clarify Description Sections (keep all 4, add signposting)

Owner's instruction: **do NOT merge / consolidate** — just make it clearer which does what.

Current layout (in the modal, top section)

```
■■ Description Template ■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■
■ [textarea with {color} placeholders] ■
■ [Generate] [Standard ▼] ■
■■ Shorter / Longer / New Variation ■■■■■ ← only shows after generation
■ [Shorter] [Longer] [New Variation] ■
■■ Unified Series Description ■■■■■■■■■■■
■ [Brief] [Standard] [Detailed] ■
■ [Quick Generate All Series] ■
■■ Manage Auto-Regeneration ■■■■■■■■■■■■■
■ [Settings…] ■
■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■
```

Problem: 4 boxes, no signposting, easy to forget which does what.

Proposed layout (same 4 sections, wrapped in a clear parent)

```
■■ ■ Descriptions ■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■
■ ■
■ ▼ Which one should I use? ■
■ • Per-product template — writes to individual products ■
■ • Unified series — writes to the collection page + ■
■ optionally propagates to each product ■
■ ■
■ 1. Per-product Description (individual products) ■
■ ■ Description Template ■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■ ■
■ ■ [textarea with {color} etc placeholders] ■ ■
■ ■ [Generate] [Standard ▼] ■ ■
■ ■ (Once generated:) [Shorter] [Longer] [New] ■ ■
■ ■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■ ■
■ ■
■ 2. Unified Series Description (collection page) ■
■ ■ Series Description ■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■ ■
■ ■ Detected series: "Sparta" (3 products selected) ■ ■
■ ■ [Brief] [Standard] [Detailed] ■ ■
■ ■ ■■■ or ■■■ ■ ■
■ ■ [Quick Generate for All Series] ■ ■
■ ■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■ ■
■ ■
■ ■ Auto-Regeneration → Manage Settings ■
■ ■
■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■
```

Changes:

- **Add** a parent "Descriptions" collapsible section wrapping everything.
- **Add** a "Which one should I use?" expandable help block.
- **Merge visually** the Description Template + Shorter/Longer/New into ONE box (they're already interlinked — Shorter/Longer only appears after Generate).
- **Rename** "Unified Series Description" → "Series Description" (shorter, clearer).
- **Show** the detected series name explicitly ("Detected series: 'Sparta' (3 products)") so user knows what will be generated.

- **Move** "Manage Auto-Regeneration" out of the four coloured boxes and into a small link at the bottom.

No functional changes. No endpoint changes. No state changes. Just visual grouping and labelling.

FILES TOUCHED

- `/app/frontend/src/pages/admin/SupplierProducts.js`
- Wrap the 4 existing description JSX blocks in a `<Section title="Descriptions">` container.
- Add the help block.
- Merge the "Description Template" + "Shorter/Longer/New" blocks (they're already conditionally rendered together).
- No changes to `handleBulkGenerateDescription`, `handleGenerateSeriesDescription`, `handleOpenBatchSeriesModal`.

LINKED FEATURES CHECKED (WILL STILL WORK)

Feature	Endpoint / Handler	Verified?
Per-product description generation	`/api/products/generate-description`	■ Endpoint untouched.
Series description generation	`/api/products/generate-series-description`	■ Endpoint untouched.
Batch series	`/api/products/generate-batch-series-descriptions`	■ Endpoint untouched.
Bulk-generate from SEO tab (uses ai_descriptions.py)	`/api/products/bulk-generate-descriptions`	■ Different tab; untouched.
Description save on Force Save	`bulkDescriptionSettings.description_template`	■ Will move into new unified save from P0-1.

P0-3: Draft Restore — Warning Banner (option b, as chosen)

Owner's choice: **warn but don't auto-discard**. Let owner decide.

Current behaviour (line 9773)

Blue banner shows "Unsaved draft found from {date}" + Restore / Discard buttons. NO age check. NO product-set match check.

Proposed change

```
■ ■ Unsaved draft from 29/05/2026, 10:14 (68 days ago) ■■■■■■■■■■
■ ■
■ Draft was for 5 products from supplier "Splendour". ■
■ You currently have 3 products from "Ceramica Impex" selected. ■
■ ■
■ ■■ The draft doesn't match your current selection. ■
■ Restoring will replace your current changes but keep your ■
■ current product selection — some draft values may not apply.■
■ ■
■ [ Restore Anyway ] [ Discard Draft ] [ Ignore ] ■
■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■
```

Rules:

- Banner colour: BLUE if ≤7 days AND same product set, AMBER if >7 days OR different products, RED if >30 days.
- Show:
- Age in human words: "just now" / "3 hours ago" / "68 days ago".
- How many products the draft was for, and how many the user has selected now.
- Which supplier the draft was for (if different from current, flag it prominently).
- 3 buttons (up from 2):
- **Restore Anyway** — same as today, forces the merge.
- **Discard Draft** — same as today.
- **Ignore** — hide the banner for this session only, keep draft on server. (For "I'll come back to this later.")

FILES TOUCHED

- `/app/frontend/src/pages/admin/SupplierProducts.js`
- `recoveredDraft` object is already returned with `updated_at`, `selected_products`, `supplier` (line 1712) — no backend change needed.
- Add helper `computeDraftFreshness(draft, currentSelectedProducts, currentSupplier)` returning `{ ageDays, sameProducts, sameSupplier, level: 'fresh' | 'stale' | 'ancient' }`.
- Update the JSX at line 9773 to render the new banner with colour + counts + Ignore button.

LINKED FEATURES CHECKED (WILL STILL WORK)

Feature	Handler	Verified?
Draft auto-save every 30s	`saveDraftToServer` (line 1691)	■ Untouched.
Draft clear on save	`clearServerDraft` (line 1764)	■ Untouched.
Draft retrieve on modal open	Similar useEffect	■ Untouched.

Summary of what changes vs stays

Changes (planned):

- `handleForceSave` — **DELETED**.
- `handleBulkCategoryUpdate` — extended with automatic per-product retry, mandatory verification, per-product result modal.

- Description sections — visually regrouped into a parent "Descriptions" container with a "which one should I use?" help block.
- Draft-restore banner — new colour-coded + age + supplier/product-mismatch warnings + Ignore button.

Stays exactly the same:

- ALL backend endpoints.
- ALL 4 description generation endpoints and their business rules.
- ALL 15 sibling components in `/components/supplier-products/`.
- `handleQuickSave` (per-attribute inline save).
- Presets, Edit History, Dry Run Preview, Manage Options, Tier Pricing, Bulk Sale.
- The 5-collection sync fan-out (`sync_staging → supplier_products → products → tiles → collection_settings`).
- Auto-publish rules.
- Undo snapshot system.
- Sub-selection Material branch — ■■ AWAITING YOUR CONFIRMATION on whether to keep it.

Blocker I need answered before I write code:

The Sub-selection Material branch at line 4306 says:

> “"If you sub-selected specific products AND set Material = something other than Porcelain, the OTHER products auto-get Porcelain."”

Is this a real business rule you use, or is it legacy weirdness we should strip? Options:

a. **Keep it** — I preserve it byte-for-byte in the new unified save path. Safe default. b. **Strip it** — this behaviour has surprised me at least once and I'd like it gone. c. **Not sure** — I'll keep it to be safe.

Answer (a/b/c) and I'll start implementing P0-1 through P0-3 in order.